

To install Nagios from EPEL, add the EPEL repository to Yum, and then install the RPMs. The instructions to add the EPEL repository (clearly mentioned on the EPEL site) are as follows:

a) Download the relevant RPM to set up the repo:

```
[vbg@prefect downloads]$ wget -c http://download.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/5/1386/epel-release-5-4.noarch.rpm
```

b) Install it:

```
[root@prefect ~]# rpm -Uvh /home/vbg/downloads/epel-release-5-4.noarch.rpm
warning: /home/vbg/downloads/epel-release-5-4.noarch.rpm:
Header V3 DSA signature: NOKEY, key ID 217521f6
Preparing... #####
##### [100%]
 1:epel-release #####
##### [100%]
```

On listing the files installed by the RPM, you will see a GPG key (for checking package signatures) and a *repo* file to identify the package source:

```
[root@prefect ~]# rpm -ql epel-release-5-4
/etc/pki/rpm-gpg/RPM-GPG-KEY-EPEL
/etc/yum.repos.d/epel-testing.repo
/etc/yum.repos.d/epel.repo
/usr/share/doc/epel-release-5
/usr/share/doc/epel-release-5/GPL
```

Let us now install Nagios:

```
[root@prefect ~]# yum clean all
Loaded plugins: rhnplugin, security
Cleaning up Everything
[root@prefect ~]# yum list nagios*
```

Experience tells us that all packages should never be installed on a host—only the desired ones should be installed. Therefore, begin with the basic packages:

```
[root@prefect ~]# yum install nagios nagios-common nagios-plugins \
nagios-plugins-http nagios-plugins-disk nagios-plugins-ping
```

Hopefully, the above packages will be installed on your system without any hiccups. Any doubts about Nagios installation being complex should now be removed.

To configure Nagios, you first need to find its configuration files—which is simple with the `rpm` tool's switches. To locate configuration files provided by the Nagios package, simply run the following command:

```
[root@prefect ~]# rpm -qc nagios
/etc/httpd/conf.d/nagios.conf
/etc/logrotate.d/nagios
/etc/nagios/cgi.cfg
/etc/nagios/commands.cfg
/etc/nagios/localhost.cfg
/etc/nagios/nagios.cfg
/etc/nagios/private/resource.cfg
```

Let's have a look at the various configuration files (each with a specific purpose), and understand how Nagios uses them. They are:

- The main configuration file (`/etc/nagios/nagios.cfg`)
- Object definition files (`/etc/nagios/commands.cfg` and `/etc/nagios/localhost.cfg`)
- Resource configuration file (`/etc/nagios/private/resource.cfg`)
- CGI configuration file (`/etc/nagios/cgi.cfg`)

The Apache configuration file (`/etc/httpd/conf.d/nagios.conf`) contains the directive for the URLs `http://<nagios-host>/nagios/` and `http://<nagios-host>/nagios/cgi-bin/`, whereas the `/etc/logrotate.d/nagios` file is a log rotation configuration file.

The main configuration file

The `/etc/nagios/nagios.cfg` file controls the behaviour of the Nagios process and also the CGIs. There are many configuration directives in this file, and all of them are well documented. Let us look at some of the more important ones to get our basic configuration going:

- **Log file:** This should be the first directive—the log file where host and service events are logged. Be careful that the file is accessible and writeable by the *nagios* user:

```
log_file=<path-of-log-file>
```

Nagios user and group: These are the user and group names under which the Nagios process runs. The Yum installation, as above, creates both a user and a group named Nagios, which we will use:

```
nagios_user=nagios
nagios_group=nagios
```

Object definition file(s): This parameter can be specified multiple times. These files contain definitions for each host and service, as well as groups of hosts and services. As an example, the Yum installation creates two object configuration files: `commands.cfg` and `localhost.cfg`. We will look at these a little later. The parameter syntax is as follows:

```
cfg_file=<path-of-object-definition-file_1>
cfg_file=<path-of-object-definition-file_2>
```